First 48 Hours After You're Served

A plain-English checklist from Ask AI Legal

- [ ] **1. Don't ignore it.**
  Court papers come with deadlines. If you miss one, the other side may be able to win without you.

- [ ] **2. Find the deadline.**
  Look for a hearing date, or words like "within 20 days." Write it on your calendar today.

- [ ] **3. Read every page.**
  Note who filed it, what they want the court to do, and the case number on the first page.

- [ ] **4. Keep everything.**
  Save the papers, the envelope, and a note of when and how you received them.

- [ ] **5. Get organized.**
  Put your papers, dates, notes, and evidence in one place.

- [ ] **6. Check for official forms.**
  Some courts require their own forms for certain requests. Check your court's website before you write anything.

- [ ] **7. Ask for help early.**
  Court facilitators, law libraries, and legal aid programs can point you in the right direction.

Want help keeping it all organized?

Ask AI Legal reads your papers, tracks your dates, and helps you prepare documents, privately on your own computer. askailegal.com